Data Handling Policy

How we protect customer, supplier and employee data

Owner	Data protection team
Applies to	All employees and contractors
Effective from	1 January 2026
Review cycle	Yearly

Read the whole policy, then complete and sign the acknowledgement form on the last page. Your manager receives a confirmation once the form is saved.

1. Purpose

This policy explains how employees of Example Corp handle customer, supplier and employee data in their daily work. It applies to every system, device and paper record that holds such data, wherever the work is done.

The policy supports the commitments the company makes to its customers in its contracts and to the authorities under data protection law. Breaking it can harm the people whose data we hold, and the company.

2. Scope

The policy covers all employees, contractors and temporary staff. Managers make sure that new team members read it during their first week and confirm it on the last page of this document.

Separate procedures cover the IT department's administration tasks and the handling of payment card data. They complement this policy and do not replace it.

3. Data classification

Every document and data set has one of four levels: Public, Internal, Confidential and Restricted. The level is set by the owner of the data and shown in the header of documents or in the metadata of the system that holds them.

Public data can be shared freely. Internal data stays within the company. Confidential data is shared only with people who need it for their work. Restricted data, such as health or salary information, is shared only with named people and always encrypted.

4. Storage and transfer

Company data is stored only in approved systems: the document management system, the CRM and the shared drives. Personal cloud storage, private e-mail accounts and removable media must not be used for company data.

Confidential and Restricted data is sent outside the company only through the secure file transfer portal or as an encrypted attachment. The password is sent through a different channel than the file.

5. Access

Access rights follow the principle of least privilege. Each employee receives the access needed for the current role, and managers review the rights of their team twice a year.

Accounts are personal. Passwords and access cards are never shared, and screens are locked whenever a workstation is left unattended, even for a short time.

6. Retention and deletion

Data is kept only as long as the retention schedule allows. Customer records are kept for seven years after the end of the contract, application files of candidates who were not hired for six months.

At the end of the retention period, data is deleted from all systems, including copies on shared drives. Paper records are shredded in the locked bins on each floor.

7. Incidents

A lost laptop, an e-mail sent to the wrong person or a suspicious login are incidents. Report them at once to the service desk, even outside office hours. The data protection team decides whether the authorities or the people concerned must be informed.

Reporting an incident quickly is never held against the person who reports it. Hiding an incident is a breach of this policy.

8. Training

Every employee completes the online data protection course each year. Teams that handle Restricted data attend an additional workshop. Completion is recorded in the learning platform.

Acknowledgement

By signing this form you confirm that you have read the Data Handling Policy, that you understand it, and that you will follow it in your daily work.

Full name _____

Department _____

Date _____

☐ I have read and understood the Data Handling Policy.

Signature _____